pitched shorter than normal, but skidded through and didn't bounce at all – that was the secret.

Warnie would bowl this ball with the same arm position and at the same arm speed – it would look like his stock ball – but then it would come out of the bottom of his hand instead, and all the speed would be generated through his wrist, which made the ball come out much quicker. Warne used to say that bowling this ball hurt his wrist, but it really was the most unbelievable delivery.

But the real secret to the delivery – and this is the part that used to bamboozle Daryll – was that because the ball was pitched shorter, Daryll thought he could play back to the bowler, and even attack. But because of the ball's flatter trajectory, it would come skidding through pretty low. And so Daryll would keep on either getting bowled or given out lbw. He just couldn't grasp the fact that he had to play forward.

I think Daryll also struggled to pick up the length of that ball. Brian McMillan was the same. Warnie got Mackie with the flipper a few times too; I remember a couple of stone-dead lbws. To be fair, there are not many batsmen on this planet who ever played Warnie with any degree of comfort.

So that was Daryll for me. Not a person I could get on with, but a great cricketer who – apart from Shane Warne – could take any bowler apart. For the last three years of Daryll's Test career, he averaged 51, which is bladdy impressive. As I said, he was the one guy I would pay money to watch.

In the following chapter, I'll give you the names of some other players whose cricketing talents I have admired through the years. Actually, there are a couple of bowlers on that list too.